



Entrepreneurs typically spend 68% of their time firefighting and only 32% on long-term planning

The Alternative Board, 2016

OPERATIONS MANUAL

As your workforce grows, you might want to consider creating an operations manual, which is a document that explains exactly how your business functions. Although they vary from business to business, they typically detail the steps used to complete your business processes; staff roles and responsibilities; best practices; and emergency procedures. Having a record of every business function is more than just a tool to train new employees—it serves to record valuable knowledge in the event of staff leaving the business.

An operations manual also makes your business far more attractive to prospective buyers. If you plan to sell or franchise your business, it is evidence that the business can run without you being present.

Cost

Flexibility

Speed

Quality

3. Flexibility

The wider the range of products/services delivered by the same process, the harder it is to deliver quality quickly. Focus on your core products/services, but stay flexible by creating alternative processes for special or unexpected orders.

4. Cost

Only once you can ensure the quality, speed, and flexibility of your processes, should you seek to improve costs. It would be a waste of time trying to address costs while other areas of your business still require improvement.